

Frequently Asked Questions

The questions our concierge is asked most often, answered in full. Current as of January 2026.

Booking, Payment and Cancellation

How do I book?

On WhatsApp, at +91 81015 61812. That is not a lead form that someone answers eventually — it is the concierge desk, staffed 24 hours, and you will be talking to a person. Email works too, at reservations@theglasshotel.example.com, and is slower.

Is it cheaper to book direct?

Yes, always, and it is the only way to get breakfast included. We never undercut our own direct rate on a travel platform.

What is your cancellation policy?

Cancellations made 8 or more days before arrival are fully refundable. Cancellations within 7 days of arrival are charged the first night of the stay. A no-show is charged the first night.

Do I have to pay in advance?

A one-night deposit confirms the booking; the balance is settled at check-out. Stays of seven nights or more take 50% fourteen days before arrival.

What payment methods do you take?

UPI, Indian and international cards, bank transfer, and cash in rupees up to ₹1,99,000 per stay. No foreign currency, no cheques, no cryptocurrency.

Are the rates inclusive of tax?

No. Rates are per room per night excluding GST, which is 18% on room tariffs above ₹7,500 — every room we have. There is no service charge or resort fee on top.

Can I get a GST invoice for my company?

Yes, if you give us the company name and GSTIN before check-out. We cannot reissue an invoice with different particulars afterwards.

Arrival, Check-in and Your Stay

What are the check-in and check-out times?

Check-in is from 2:00 PM and check-out is until 11:00 AM. If you need early check-in or late check-out, contact us in advance and we will do our best based on availability — usually free of charge.

I arrive at 6:00 AM off the overnight train. What happens?

Reception is staffed all night, so someone will be expecting you. We will store your luggage, give you breakfast and the run of the estate, and put you in the room as soon as it is ready. To have the room guaranteed at 6:00 AM, book the previous night at half rate.

What ID do I need?

Photo ID for every adult guest — Aadhaar, passport, driving licence or voter ID for Indian nationals; passport and visa for foreign nationals, for whom we also file Form C with the FRRO.

Is there parking?

Yes — complimentary secure valet parking on the premises, covered and inside the gate, staffed 24 hours.

Do you have Wi-Fi?

Complimentary high-speed Starlink Wi-Fi throughout the property, with no device or time limit. It slows in very heavy rain, and we will lend you a 4G hotspot when that happens.

Can I have visitors?

In the public areas between 8:00 AM and 9:00 PM, signed in at reception with photo ID. Not in guest rooms, and not at the pool or spa.

What time is breakfast?

7:00 to 10:30 AM, in the restaurant, on your terrace or in your room — all at no extra charge.

Rooms, Children and Pets

Which room should I book?

Two people who want the view: The Panorama Pavilion. Two people who want quiet and intimacy: The Mist Suite. A family of four, or two couples: The Obsidian Villa. Five or six: the Villa plus the Mist Suite, at 10% off the pair.

Are pets allowed?

We love animals, but to ensure the comfort of all our guests and protect the local wildlife, we do not allow pets at the property. Recognised assistance animals are welcome and are not covered by this policy.

Are children welcome?

Very much so. Under 6 stay and eat breakfast free sharing existing bedding; 6–12 are ₹2,500 a night on an extra bed; cots are free. Only The Panorama Pavilion takes an extra bed.

Can I smoke?

Not indoors, anywhere, including e-cigarettes. Balconies, decks and the designated garden area are fine. Smoking in a room costs ₹15,000 in deep cleaning.

Is the property accessible?

Partly, and we are specific about it. The Panorama Pavilion, reception, lounge and restaurant are step-free with lift access. The Mist Suite has fourteen steps and no lift; the spa has three steps and cannot be adapted. Ask us before booking and we will send photographs and measurements.

Is there air conditioning?

Yes — smart climate control with heating, cooling and heated floors in every room. Honestly, at 1,650 m you will use the heating far more than the cooling.

Food, Drink and the Spa

Is breakfast included?

Yes, a complimentary artisanal breakfast is included with all direct bookings, for every guest in the room. We cater to various dietary requirements if notified in advance.

I am vegan / Jain / gluten-free / allergic. Can you cook for me?

Vegan, vegetarian, gluten-free and dairy-free need no notice. Jain and severe nut allergies need 12 hours so the kitchen can dedicate a station. If an allergy is anaphylactic, talk to us before booking — one kitchen cannot promise an allergen-free environment and we would rather say so.

Can I eat in my room?

At any hour, from the full menu until 10:30 PM and a night menu after. No tray charge, ever.

Is there a bar? What is the drinking age?

Yes, open noon to midnight; 18 is the legal age in Sikkim. Bring your own bottle if you like — corkage is ₹1,500 in the restaurant and free in your room.

Is the pool heated? Is there a lifeguard?

Heated to 30°C year-round, open 6:30 AM to 8:00 PM. There is no lifeguard — swimming is at your own risk and under-14s must be accompanied in the water.

What is a Dotsho bath?

A traditional hot stone bath: river stones heated in a fire for hours, then lowered into a wooden tub of herb-infused water. ₹6,500 single, ₹11,000 for a couple. Book by 2:00 PM for the same evening — the fire needs four hours.

Travel, Permits and Weather

Which airport, and how long is the drive?

Bagdogra (IXB), 124 km and 4–5 hours by road. Pakyong (PYG) is only an hour away but its schedule is thin and weather-dependent. Take a morning flight into Bagdogra so the mountain drive happens in daylight.

Can you arrange the transfer?

Yes — a private SUV from Bagdogra is ₹9,500 each way, from NJP railhead ₹9,000, from Pakyong ₹3,000. Book 48 hours ahead.

Do I need a permit for Sikkim?

Not for Sikkim or Gangtok. You need an Inner Line Permit for Tsomgo Lake and Nathula Pass; foreign nationals need a Protected Area Permit and cannot visit Nathula at all. Our concierge arranges these with photo ID and two photographs, in one to two working days.

When is the best time to visit?

Mid-October to early December for the clearest Kanchenjunga views. April for rhododendrons and warmth. The monsoon, June to mid-September, is green, dramatic, quiet and cheap — with a real chance of road delays.

What happens if a landslide closes the road?

If NH10 is shut and you cannot reach Gangtok on your arrival date, we hold the full value of your booking as credit for twelve months rather than charging a cancellation fee.

Does it snow?

Not in Gangtok in a normal winter. It snows above 3,000 m, which closes Nathula and sometimes Tsomgo from December to February.

Will I get altitude sickness?

Unlikely at 1,650 m — you may sleep lightly the first night. The excursions to 12,400 ft and above are a real risk; give yourself a day in Gangtok first and descend at the first stubborn headache.

Celebrations, Events and Everything Else

We are on honeymoon. Do you do anything for that?

Tell us when you book and the courtesies are free — flowers, a decorated room, something on ice, a private table. The full celebration set-up with cake and decor is ₹6,500.

Can we get married / hold an event here?

Under a whole-estate buyout, yes — three rooms, exclusive use, ₹1,15,000 per night for up to nine guests staying, and up to forty people on the lower terrace for the event itself. Weddings are quoted individually.

Can we shoot photography or video here?

Personal photography, always and everywhere. Commercial or pre-wedding shoots need permission and a fee, because they occupy space other guests have paid for. Drones are not permitted at all — this is restricted airspace near an international border.

Do you have a laundry service?

Yes, 24-hour turnaround, or 6-hour express at 1.5×. Dry-cleaning goes to Siliguri and takes 48–72 hours.

Is there a doctor if I need one?

A local GP will come to the estate within about an hour, ₹1,500–₹2,500. STNM Hospital is 4 km away and there is a 24-hour pharmacy at Deorali. We keep oxygen and an AED at reception.

Where can I change money or find an ATM?

There is no exchange counter on the estate. Licensed changers and several ATMs are on MG Marg, ten minutes away. Carry some cash — small shops and taxis outside town are cash-only.

I left something in my room. Can you send it?

We hold lost property for 90 days and will courier anywhere in India at cost, usually ₹400–₹900.